Outdoor Cooking Equipment

Category: **Food Processing & Kitchen** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 1 labs

Covers these lab items: Outdoor cooking equipment, such as stoves, pots, and reusable utensils

What it is used for

Outdoor cooking equipment includes portable stoves, pots and reusable utensils used to prepare food outside a kitchen. Safe setup, clean handling and proper fuel management help prevent burns, fires and food contamination.

Main parts

- Identify the stove body, burner and designated fuel connection.
- Locate the fuel cylinder, cartridge or supply line, depending on the stove.
- Identify the ignition control, flame adjustment and shut-off valve.
- Locate the cooking pot, pan, lid and heat-resistant handles.
- Identify reusable spoons, ladles, tongs and serving utensils.
- Locate the stable supporting stand and wind protection, if provided.
- Identify cleaning supplies, heat-resistant gloves and suitable fire-extinguishing equipment.

Before you start

1. Choose a stable, level outdoor location away from dry vegetation and combustible materials.
2. Check local fire restrictions and ensure adequate ventilation.
3. Inspect the stove, fuel hose, regulator and connections for damage or leaks.
4. Keep fuel containers upright and away from direct heat.
5. Wash hands and clean pots and reusable utensils before cooking.
6. Prepare fresh ingredients and keep raw foods separate from cooked foods.
7. Keep a suitable fire extinguisher or other recommended fire-control equipment accessible.

How to use

1. Set up the stove on a stable, non-combustible surface outdoors.
2. Connect the approved fuel supply according to the stove instructions.
3. Check fuel connections for leaks using the manufacturer's recommended method.
4. Place the pot securely on the stove support before ignition where required.
5. Ignite the burner according to the instructions and adjust the flame safely.
6. Add ingredients using clean utensils and avoid overfilling the pot.
7. Cook food thoroughly while monitoring the flame and pot stability.
8. Use heat-resistant gloves or suitable tools when handling hot cookware.
9. Turn off the burner and close the fuel supply after cooking.
10. Allow cookware to cool before washing and packing the equipment.

⚠ Safety

- Never use outdoor fuel-burning stoves inside enclosed rooms or poorly ventilated spaces.
- Keep children, loose clothing and combustible materials away from the flame.
- Never leave a lit stove unattended or move it while hot.
- Do not use equipment with leaking fuel connections or damaged hoses.
- Never pour water onto burning cooking oil or grease.
- If a fuel leak or uncontrolled fire occurs, shut off fuel only if safe, move away and call emergency services.

Care & storage

- Allow the stove and cookware to cool completely before cleaning.
- Wash reusable utensils with suitable detergent and safe water, then dry them.
- Inspect burners, hoses and connectors before storage.
- Store clean, dry equipment and fuel containers separately in appropriate locations.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Setting up the stove on an unstable surface or near dry vegetation.
- Ignoring fuel leaks or using an unsuitable fuel connection.
- Leaving cooked food exposed to insects, dust or raw-food contamination.
- Packing hot equipment or storing fuel near heat sources.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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